dedicated team was dispatched to the village to assemble Anganwadi workers and teachers.

The ensuing interaction during the Yatra was undeniably memorable. Rahul Gandhi's genuine interest in the lives of ordinary people became palpable. When inquiring about the most significant issues perceived by working women in the unorganized sector, Savithri Amma candidly responded, 'Alcohol, sir.' Rahul ji delved deeper, questioning, 'Why alcohol?' Savithri responded with the utmost honesty, 'Because our men become very strong after drinking it, and they start physically abusing us.'

Rahul ji then posed a question that momentarily broke the gravity with innocent laughter. 'Why do you allow him to hit you? Have you ever tried to fight back?' The room echoed with laughter as Savithri replied. 'He will do that to you only when you allow him that privilege.' Rahul ji's response was empowering, affirming that while the Congress party would work to address the issue of alcohol abuse, it was crucial for women to assert themselves and take action when necessary. The interaction encapsulated a blend of serious concerns and shared laughter, underscoring the profound engagement that transpired during the Yatra.

Bringing the Language of the Congress to the Forefront

The Bharat Jodo Yatra successfully rejuvenated the language and values intrinsic to the Congress party, effectively bridging the divide between the party and its ideological foundations. The Congress has historically eschewed reliance on mere rhetoric or charismatic orators, opting instead for communication through action, particularly by padyatra. Even during the tumultuous period of Independence marked by communal riots, Congress leaders, led by Mahatma Gandhi, connected with the populace not through grandiloquent speeches, but by traversing the villages of Bengal. 'The Walk' and fasting constituted Mahatma Gandhi's preferred instruments of communication. These walks afforded an intimate, human-sized glimpse into the lives of the country's people, facilitating personal connections and